



What Comes First?

Quick facilitation notes & answer key

Goal

Children identify the step that must happen first in a two-step action. Recognizing the starting step — and that some steps depend on earlier ones — is essential to building a correct sequence or algorithm.

Kindergarten frame (Ontario)

Problem Solving and Innovating — children reason about the order in which steps must occur.

No reading required of the child: read each prompt aloud; the child circles the first step.

Materials

The printed worksheet + a pencil. Optional: act out each two-step action so children feel the order.

Run it (about 15 min)

1. MODEL: the slide — 'you must climb up BEFORE you slide down.' First is ↑.
2. GUIDED: Exercise 1 — to get to the top, climb up comes first.
3. YOU TRY: children pick the first step for the door (open) and for getting dressed (sock).
4. Connect: 'If you do steps out of order, the plan does not work — order matters.'

Answer key (modelled by the run-gate)

Model — slide: first ↑ climb up, then ↓ slide down.

Ex 1 — circle ↑ climb up. Ex 2 — circle 'open the door'.

Ex 3 — circle 'put on a sock' (the sock goes on before the shoe).

Watch for & differentiate

Common slip: picking the more exciting step (the slide!) — ask 'but what has to happen first?'

Simplify: physically act out the two steps in order, then ask which was first.

Extend: ask what comes LAST, or add a middle step (climb, sit, slide).

Movement option: do 'shoes' as a class — everyone mimes sock first, then shoe.

Success looks like

The child circles the step that must happen first in each pair and can explain why it cannot be skipped.